

Compaq V2036AP

Compaq's V2036AP is a neat-looking 14-inch widescreen laptop. This notebook sports a black-and-brushed metal finish and weighs just 2.36 kg. Powered by a Pentium M 1.7 GHz Dothan processor with 256 MB of DDR memory, it can handle most office and multimedia applications with ease. The build quality is great, and the layout of the ports on either side makes them easily accessible. Goodies include a combo drive, 802.11b wireless LAN, a 6-in-1 card reader, a FireWire port and JBL Pro speakers. The battery life at 150 minutes was average, and less than similar models we have tested. Thankfully, though, it's a quiet operator and the battery doesn't heat up too much!



Company **Hewlett Packard India Ltd**
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Rating:

Microsoft Fingerprint Reader

Forget Your Passwords

Someone had to cash in on the growing paranoia about security, and Microsoft is leading the pack—stepping in with the Fingerprint Reader. This USB device eliminates the need to type in passwords, and ships with a software disk and manual with minimal information.

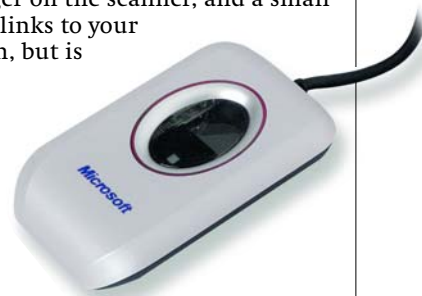
Setup is simple, with a graphical representation of both hands shown on screen. Simply click on the finger to register that finger's print. You can register all your fingers if you like!

Akin to an auto form completer, this thing allows you to register any password field. Just put your registered finger on the scanner while the password entry window is selected, and input your username and password. Useful for logging into Messengers, e-mail accounts and more!

Another neat feature is having shortcuts to Web sites on its one-touch menu. Just put your registered finger on the scanner, and a small menu pops up from the system tray with links to your registered Web sites. It works like a charm, but is expensively priced at Rs 4,514.

Company **Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd**
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Web site **www.microsoft.com**

Rating:



New & Notable

Logitech MX-1000 Cordless Mouse

The MX series of mice from Logitech are revered by the gaming community as the best piece of hardware a gamer can get his hands on. Until recently, the MX series boasted of an 800 dpi optical sensor that was precise to the last millimetre and resulted in accurate tracking of the mouse pointer on the screen. Now, with the introduction of the MX-1000,

Logitech is on the verge of triggering a revolution. Instead of an LED light source though, the MX-1000 uses a laser for accuracy—as opposed to ordinary light, a laser beam is more coherent and results in minimum scattering when it hits a surface.

The MX-1000 has eight buttons that can be programmed to one's liking using the simple-to-use 'Set Point' application. It uses RF for communication and can be controlled from as far as ten feet away. Most interestingly, Logitech

has included a rechargeable Li-ion battery, akin to those in cell-phones. But eventually, at Rs 5,500, the MX-1000 is a piece of luxury.



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Rating:

Nokia 6670

Business As Usual

It is not often that Nokia releases a phone that resembles an existing model, at least in terms of design if not on the whole. At first glance, the Nokia 6670 can easily be mistaken for a 7610. Nokia has sculpted the 6670 along the lines of the stylish 7610, though it restrained itself on the keypad design to advocate this model's business goals.

Based on the Series-60 platform, the 6670 has all the traits of the business series, including tri-band operation, Bluetooth, a 65K colour screen, a 1-megapixel camera, 8 MB of internal memory—enough to store your business contacts—and a 64 MB MMC card. This time round, Nokia has provided the NetFront Web browser as the built-in option. NetFront supports all major Web standards and is more accurate in the layout of pages, thanks to which pages look similar to what they look like on a desktop. However, considering the small screen size, its usefulness is questionable.

As far as its core competence—the phone—goes, the device is like any other Nokia phone—good signal reception and voice quality. However, on the usability front, the tacky keys do not help much. Being a business phone, this should be of paramount importance since it is the only mode of data input. We think the 6670 is a stopgap measure from Nokia to kill time before it releases the much-awaited 6630.



Company **Nokia India Ltd**
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Rating: